

STREAMER SCHOOL

2.5-Hour Foundations Clinic · Student Handout · Condensed from the Full Program

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2.5 hrs 8:00 AM–10:30 AM	~1.5 hrs ON-WATER TIME	5 SESSIONS	3 PILLARS INTRODUCED
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Fly Design · Color Theory · Retrieval Vocabulary · Water Reading

Resources: Leader Construction · Fly Casting Terms & Definitions · Fly Fishing Terms & Definitions

QUICK REFERENCE — FLY CATEGORIES: SIX TYPES AND THEIR BEHAVIOR

CATEGORY	BEHAVIOR & BEST USE
Jigger	Dumbbell or tungsten eyes. Heavy, sinks fast. Vertical bounce on pause. Near-bottom cold-water tool.
Swimmer	Conehead or no weight. Fast, continuous retrieve. Materials shed water and dart. Clear, cold conditions.
Diver	Deer hair or foam head. Buoyant, dives on strip, surfaces on pause. Creates direction change and turbulence.
Walker	Wedge head. Erratic side-to-side on strip. Reaction-strike trigger.

COLOR MATCHING — CONDITIONS TO COLOR LOGIC

CONDITIONS	COLOR LOGIC
Clear Water + Bright Sun	Natural tones: olive, white, tan, brown — fish inspect closely; sparse flash only
Stained / Off-Color	High contrast: black, chartreuse, purple, fire orange — silhouette over shade
Turbid / Dirty Water	Loudest possible: chartreuse, yellow, hot orange — lateral line + maximum visibility
Rotation Rule	Natural first → stained: step louder every 20 min with no contact → shift one step per condition change

RETRIEVAL VOCABULARY — KEY RETRIEVES

RETRIEVE	EXECUTION & TRIGGER
Strip-Strip-Pause	Two pulls, pause — fly flutters like injured prey. Foundation of all streamer retrieves.

RETRIEVE	EXECUTION & TRIGGER
Jerk-Strip	Rod jerk + line strip in rapid succession — erratic direction change on every beat.
Slow Glide	Long slow strips, extended pause — cold, inactive, or pressured fish in deep pools.

THE DECISION SEQUENCE — HOW TO CHOOSE ON THE WATER

#	STEP	DETAIL
1	Read Conditions	What is the water clarity? What is the light? What is the weather doing?
2	Select Color	Apply physics: clear+sun=natural; stained=contrast; dirty=loud; low light=dark silhouette.
3	Select Retrieve	Start with strip-strip-pause. Adjust cadence, speed, and direction based on fish response.
4	Cover Water	Cast angle → retrieve → step → repeat. First cast to every lie is the highest-probability presentation.

2.5-Hour Foundations Clinic

8:00 – 8:20 am Fly design & color theory overview

FLY DESIGN + COLOR

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Understand the three fly categories: jigger, swimmer, and diver/walker
- Apply the contrast-over-color rule to stained and turbid water

KEY CONCEPTS

Three categories: jigger (vertical), swimmer (continuous fast retrieve), diver/walker (direction change) · Clear + sun: natural tones; stained: high contrast; dirty: loudest possible · Rotation: natural first → step louder every 20 min with no contact

ACTIVITIES

- Fly board: students call the swimming category for a few patterns
- River condition read: instructor calls today's conditions, students select color from their box

Checkpoint: Each student correctly categorizes a sample pattern and assigns color logic to today's conditions.

8:20 – 8:30 am · Walk to water

8:30 – 9:25 am Retrieval mechanics — strip-strip-pause, jerk-strip & direction change**RETRIEVAL****LEARNING OBJECTIVES**

- Execute strip-strip-pause, jerk-strip, and slow glide with distinct cadence
- Understand why change of direction triggers more strikes than speed alone

KEY CONCEPTS

Strip-strip-pause: foundation — two pulls, flutter on pause — injured prey · Jerk-strip: rod jerk + line strip — erratic high-speed direction change on every beat · Change of direction: most consistent trigger — fly changes direction = escaping prey

ACTIVITIES

- Retrieval drill: several retrieves, several casts each — execute distinctly and name each one
- Fly watch in flat water: observe own fly's behavior on each retrieve type

Checkpoint: Each student demonstrates 3 distinct retrieves with clearly different cadence.

9:25 – 10:00 am Reading water for streamers & the approach cast**WATER READING****LEARNING OBJECTIVES**

- Target undercut banks, wood, and depth transitions as ambush architecture
- Apply the first-cast rule: make the first presentation count

KEY CONCEPTS

Ambush architecture: structure + depth transition + adjacent current · Undercut banks: closest to the bank wins — 5 hard strips then move on · First cast rule: first presentation to any new lie = highest-probability cast

ACTIVITIES

- Lie identification: student walks a stretch and assigns a retrieve approach to each feature
- Bank-targeting: land fly within 18 inches of bank

Checkpoint: Each student correctly identifies 2–3 lie types and lands casts within 18 inches of the bank.

10:00 – 10:20 am Line systems & independent practice**LINES + APPLIED****LEARNING OBJECTIVES**

- Match line density to water depth and fly category
- Self-select fly, color, and retrieve for a short independent stretch

KEY CONCEPTS

Floating: maximum fly action — shallow water, banks, active fish · Sink tip Type 3–5: most common river choice — depth + casting ease of floating running line

ACTIVITIES

- Line comparison: same fly on floating and sink tip — student describes the behavioral difference
- Short independent water hunt with self-directed decisions

Checkpoint: Each student selects a line for today's water and can explain the behavioral impact on the fly.

10:20 – 10:30 am Final debrief & written feedback

REVIEW

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Receive individual written feedback
- Identify one priority to build on

ACTIVITIES

- Written instructor assessment returned to each student
- One strength and one priority — verbal

Checkpoint: Each student leaves with one written strength and one named priority for the next time on the water.